

Lia — Session Summary

The whole build, one line at a time.

Every exchange in the build of Lia, one line for what was asked and a short account of what came of it. Times and tool counts come from Claude Code's session log; the full wording is in *Lia — Session Transcript*.

96 exchanges	1559 tool calls	01 Aug, 12:52 started	~119 hrs elapsed
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Getting her talking

1 01 Aug, 12:52 10 tools	Introduced the project; stuck because the editor's Run button can't take typed input. Confirmed the code was fine by running it end to end. The fix was a real terminal. Flagged that DB_PATH was relative, so launching from the wrong folder would silently create a second, empty memory.
2 01 Aug, 13:26 24 tools	Typed something and nothing came back. Not broken — silent . Replies were fetched whole before printing, so ~20s passed with a blank screen. Added token streaming and progress markers. Also found fact extraction was storing nothing, and made DB_PATH absolute.
3 01 Aug, 13:41 34 tools	Rename Aurora to LIA; add voice, with room to add my own voices later. Built the whole voice layer: Piper for speech, a voices/ folder you drop .onnx files into, sentence-chunked speech so she starts talking before the reply finishes, and Whisper for listening.
4 01 Aug, 13:58 10 tools	Fix the two things you flagged. Diary was narrating as if it were the human — caused by user:/assistant: labels. Relabelled to Them/Lia . Added a deterministic filter so junk like name: "you" can't overwrite real facts.
5 01 Aug, 14:03 5 tools	Analyse the project. Found the biggest quality flaw: half her recall was her own past replies , unlabelled, which she read back as fact. Also: diary written but never read, no sense of time, embeddings stored as JSON (10× bloat). Measured the scan cost and said plainly it wasn't worth optimising yet.
6 01 Aug, 14:06 2 tools	Fix line 8, column 16. Type checker couldn't verify sys.stdout.reconfigure. Switched to getattr, which is also more honest about why the guard exists.
7 01 Aug, 14:10 5 tools	Is everything fine? Explain the directories. All modules compiled and ran. Caught her confabulating in that very run — inventing that you'd been nervous. Mapped the folder layout and the strict layering.
8 01 Aug, 14:13 1 tools	How do I run it? The command, what to expect, and why to type <i>bye</i> rather than closing the window.

Giving her a voice

- 9**
01 Aug, 14:22
10 tools
- Set it up so I can talk to her by voice.**
Upgraded to `small.en` after testing showed `base.en` heard “*Ania*” for “*Anaya*”. Biased recognition using names she already knows, which fixed her own name coming out as “*Leah*”.
-
- 10**
01 Aug, 14:31
2 tools
- What if she were an app I just open my laptop to?**
Measured the real gap: cold start 9.3s vs 2.4s warm. Laid out five things standing in the way and staged them, flagging that **sessions never ending** would mean an always-on Lia never learns.
-
- 11**
01 Aug, 14:39
26 tools
- Build stage 1.**
Models kept warm, sessions that close themselves after 12 quiet minutes, launcher and autostart script. Found the hidden bottleneck: Ollama's default 32k context was running **63% of her on CPU**. Pinning 8192 cut reply time by a quarter.
-
- 12**
01 Aug, 15:54
31 tools
- Do the retrieval fix, then stage 2.**
Retrieval limited to your words with timestamps. Added open-mic listening with Silero VAD, keyboard-vs-mic arbitration, and mic gating. Fixed her reading stage directions aloud.
-

Turning her into an app

- 13**
01 Aug, 16:03
14 tools
- Make her an app I can add to startup.**
Tray app with no window — only possible because voice detection removed the need for a keyboard. Verified quitting still writes her diary first.
-
- 14**
01 Aug, 16:15
49 tools
- Add a wake word, an exe, and tell me how to start.**
Wake word matched **on the transcript** rather than a trained model — no dataset needed, and it tolerates Whisper's spellings. Built the exe. Made paths survive being frozen.
-
- 15**
01 Aug, 19:57
1 tools
- How do I get her into startup?**
The one command, and what it actually does.
-
- 16**
01 Aug, 19:58
1 tools
- If I restart now, will she be there?**
No — I'd built the installer but deliberately not run it. Said so plainly.
-
- 17**
01 Aug, 20:00
5 tools
- Do it.**
Installed. Hit a real bug of my own: PowerShell variable names are case-insensitive, so my local `$exe` collided with the `-Exe` switch. Verified by launching the shortcut.
-
- 18**
01 Aug, 20:03
1 tools
- Confirm she'll be there after a restart.**
Yes — both she and Ollama were in the Startup folder.
-

Making her yours

19	Greet me, call me Warlock, and can she learn things like Morse code?
01 Aug, 20:05 17 tools	Greeting generated from her diary, which finally made the diary useful. Tested Morse honestly: she fails even with a perfect reference table in front of her . Not a memory problem — tokenisation. The fix would be code, not teaching.
20	A folder for PDFs, and make her voice softer.
01 Aug, 20:19 36 tools	Built the library with page-level citation. Stripped repeated page headers that were poisoning every search. Played four voice options rather than guessing.
21	Amy as she was, and make sure she says Warlock.
01 Aug, 20:54 10 tools	Reverted the softening. Found the name had reverted on its own — extraction re-derived the old one from stored turns. Added protected facts and purged the stale references.
22	Thanks.
01 Aug, 21:01 0 tools	—
23	Can I say “Lia stop” to stop her listening?
01 Aug, 21:04 1 tools	No. It would just become conversation. And she can't hear you at all while speaking. Said so rather than implying it half-worked.
24	What do you mean?
01 Aug, 21:08 0 tools	Re-explained without jargon: what barge-in is, why speakers break it, why headphones don't.
25	I use both.
01 Aug, 21:09 18 tools	Built spoken commands, and made interrupting work on speakers too — she compares what she hears against what she's currently saying , so her own voice is recognised and ignored.

Fixing what the real world broke

26	She didn't respond after a restart, and the diary won't open.
01 Aug, 21:34 33 tools	Three causes: she spent four minutes re-reading a PDF before speaking (absolute paths made it look new), speech recognition loaded after the greeting, and ignored speech was logged nowhere. The diary was fine — there was simply nothing to write yet.
27	I didn't want her going through PDFs on her own. And remove Anaya and Kamala.
01 Aug, 22:13 12 tools	Made the library strictly on-demand. Removed all of it — and said plainly that I had invented Anaya, Kamala, Maya and Biscuit during my own testing . Undid my overreach of having her read your PDF unasked.
28	The tray boxes were unchecked and she's not responding.
01 Aug, 22:33 18 tools	She'd asked how your day was, then ignored “hello” — my overcorrection from the previous fix. Gave the greeting a 30s reply window. The unchecked boxes were real: the Ollama wait blocked before the tray was told her state.
29	“Failed to import embedded python interpreter.”
02 Aug, 07:15 7 tools	You'd launched her mid-rebuild — my fault for rebuilding while she was in your startup. Builds now stage and swap, so a failed build leaves the working app untouched.

30

02 Aug, 07:24
1 tools

Should Ollama stay in startup?

Yes, and it's safer — when Windows starts it, it never touches her folder. Cost measured at ~130 MB RAM and no GPU while idle.

31

02 Aug, 07:26
14 tools

Is there a better approach than that trade-off?

Yes — my framing was wrong. The keep-alive timer **resets on every request**, so it only governs idle time. She now releases the models when a conversation ends and starts reloading the moment you speak.

Writing it down

32

02 Aug, 07:39
11 tools

Make a PDF of the changes, and a beginner's guide.

Both written, including the limitations rather than only the wins.

33

02 Aug, 09:23
1 tools

Is the project completed?

Working and deployed, but not finished: no way to forget, still embroiders, no tests, drifting fact keys, and two of your original roadmap items unbuilt.

34

02 Aug, 09:27
7 tools

A PDF of just our chats, for tracking.

Found Claude Code's own session log on disk and generated a 47-page transcript from the real record rather than from memory.

35

02 Aug, 09:31
4 tools

I wanted that summarised.

This document.

Connecting her to the world

36

02 Aug, 09:52
34 tools

Three things: replies feel slow, she should say "you" rather than the name every time, and whether to add Groq for internet access given an unreliable connection.

Measured the real per-turn cost and found a genuine bug: the same sentence was being embedded **twice** per turn (memory and library lookups). Fixed by sharing one embedding call, and skipping retrieval entirely on short replies like "yeah". Softened the system prompt to prefer "you". Built weather (Open-Meteo, no key needed) and an online-lookup path via Groq — with the honest caveat that a plain Groq call has no more live internet access than the local model does either.

37

02 Aug, 10:20
33 tools

Handed over a Groq key, confirmed the media player is just "Windows," and asked about adding custom voice files.

Set the key as a Windows environment variable, never in a file. While wiring it in, found the key had been pasted directly into `internet.py` and something had already stripped it back out, leaving broken syntax that would have crashed the whole app on next launch — fixed and verified. Built Windows media control (play/pause/skip/now-playing) via System Media Transport Controls, verified against a real session already running on the machine.

3802 Aug, 10:46
63 tools

Asked whether voice model files could be used, and whether an OpenRouter key would help — then linked KittenTTS specifically for its "Bella" voice.

Built OpenRouter support: with both keys present she now prefers OpenRouter's :online mode — a genuine web search — over Groq's plain guess. Getting Bella working meant fixing three separate upstream packaging bugs in KittenTTS (a required dependency version that doesn't exist on PyPI, a hardcoded Windows path to eSpeak, a data path baked in from the CI machine that built it). Verified working end to end, but left the active voice on amy since that was already the confirmed choice.

3902 Aug, 11:30
37 tools

Provided the OpenRouter key, confirmed amy as the voice, and asked for a latency check plus updated PDFs.

Verified OpenRouter's live search with a real, current, cited answer a local or Groq-only model couldn't have known. Measured all four internet paths cleanly: weather ~1.2s, connectivity check ~0.3s, Groq ~0.4–0.8s (fast, guesses), OpenRouter ~2.4–4.0s (slower, because it's actually searching). Confirmed the new trigger checks add no measurable cost to ordinary conversation. This document, and the three others.

4002 Aug, 11:47
0 tools

Good work.

—

What daily use surfaced

4102 Aug, 11:52
29 tools

Asked when a restart is actually needed versus just running her file, and how long to wait before speaking after one.

Found a real gap while answering: nothing stopped her running twice if launched by hand while the autostart copy was still up — two processes would fight over the same microphone. Added a Windows single-instance lock, tested across genuinely separate processes including surviving a forced kill, before answering the actual question: no restart needed, just run Lia.exe; wait for her audible greeting, that's the cue she's ready.

4202 Aug, 12:25
8 tools

Provided two new keys after the leak, and asked to properly ensure the gitignore actually works.

Set both new keys as environment variables and verified them working. Found the gitignore alone had done nothing, since .claude/, build/ and dist/ were already tracked in git — untracked 2019 files with git rm --cached without touching a single file on disk, so the gitignore could actually take effect from here on.

4302 Aug, 13:50
42 tools

Five conclusions from actually living with her: CPU usage over 50%, music and alarms that didn't work, remove KittenTTS, rename her to Wade, and get web search genuinely working.

Measured the CPU complaint rather than guessing at it — the voice-detection library's ONNX runtime was spinning at ~290% of one core, continuously, while sitting completely idle. One environment variable fixed it, verified down to ~4% on the real packaged app. Built alarms and timers from nothing, including a background watchdog and persistence across restarts — caught and fixed a real parsing bug ("for 10 minutes" misread as a clock time) before it shipped. Made music commands admit honestly when there's nothing to play, after catching her invent a fake jazz playlist once during testing. Removed KittenTTS entirely, dropping the packaged app by 112MB. Renamed her to Wade. Broadened and verified the web-search path end to end with the new keys.

4402 Aug, 14:17
0 tools

(a tool call was interrupted mid-turn)

—

45

02 Aug, 14:17
49 tools

Try again.

Re-ran the interrupted step and continued the same round of fixes.

46

02 Aug, 14:56
27 tools

Asked for the PDFs to be brought current, plus a new study reference covering the tools used in the project — NumPy and the rest.

This document, and the other three.

Learning to recognise her

47

02 Aug, 15:41
55 tools

Wanted a Growth Log PDF tracking her build stages — making her, file reading, voices and ML models, controlling actions — to replace the old "what we built" PDF. Asked in passing whether she can actually control playback and volume, since she can't "phase out of the hypervisor" to do it herself.

Built `Lia - Growth Log.pdf` across those four stages and deleted the old `Lia - What We Built.pdf` and its generator. Play/pause already worked through Windows' own media transport, but volume control genuinely didn't exist — built it against the Core Audio API via `pycaw` after confirming a simulated key-press approach silently did nothing at all.

48

02 Aug, 16:14
3 tools

Asked to keep the docs current from here on without being asked each time, and floated the idea of her telling your voice apart from anyone else's before committing to it.

Weighed it rather than jumping to code — a wrong call cuts both ways, refusing you or trusting an impostor. Agreed a local voiceprint model was worth trying before any of the actions built on top of it.

49

02 Aug, 16:20
0 tools

Sketched the behaviour: greet normally when it's really him, go cautious rather than act normally if the voice doesn't match.

Built `speaker_id.py` — a local voice-embedding model (3D-Speaker's CAM++ via `sherpa-onnx`, no PyTorch), enrolled from a few repetitions of his name and compared against everything said after.

50

02 Aug, 16:23
106 tools

When she doesn't recognise the voice, she shouldn't share personal details, and every action should be gated — not just the ones that happen to touch a browser.

Gated media and volume commands on a voice mismatch, and held personal facts back from the reply context on the same signal.

51

02 Aug, 17:29
29 tools

The actual spec: lock every session by default. Say "it's Wade" or get asked for a spoken passcode ("ENCODE") — get it wrong and she stops listening outright. A second passcode ("DECODE") makes her read and explain a specific reference PDF.

Built the session-level access gate — `check_access_gate()`, a hard lockout on a wrong passcode recoverable only by hand, and `explain_document()` for DECODE. Found and fixed two real bugs along the way: saying "bye" while locked was treated as a wrong passcode guess instead of exiting, and a second, unrelated bug where the keyboard-input thread spun at full CPU once `stdin` hit EOF.

52

02 Aug, 17:52
58 tools

(a tool call was interrupted mid-turn) Try again.

Re-ran the interrupted step and caught a real bug this pass: saying the identity phrase in the same breath as a request ("it's Wade, play some music") was losing the identity claim, because the request got rewritten to a command first. Fixed by checking for the claim on the raw words, before any rewriting happens.

Locking the gate down

5302 Aug, 18:35
19 tools**Flag the passcode.**

Moved `PASSCODE_UNLOCK` out of `config.py` and into an environment variable, the same pattern as the API keys — a plaintext passcode sitting in a file headed for a public repo isn't a passcode. Left unset, the gate now disables itself gracefully with a one-time log line, rather than locking anyone out with something that can never match.

5402 Aug, 18:49
17 tools**Asked if everything was in order, and for the PDFs and `requirements.txt` to be brought current.**

Audited `requirements.txt` against every actual import across the codebase, including the lazy, function-local ones — found a real gap, `pypdf` was used but never listed. Regenerated the PDFs.

5502 Aug, 18:58
0 tools**Floated camera access, flagging the security angle himself before asking.**

Talked it through rather than building anything — a live camera is a much bigger step than anything shipped so far, and the concern he raised on his own was the right one to weigh first.

Deciding what's next

5602 Aug, 19:07
0 tools**Refined the camera idea to "look at something, discuss it, maybe search online" — asked to be corrected if internet access isn't real, and whether a week of daily use is a good idea before more changes.**

Confirmed the internet path is real but narrow: weather needs no key at all, factual lookups go through Groq or OpenRouter's actual web search once a key is set, nothing beyond that. Agreed the week-of-real-use idea was the right next step before adding anything else, especially to calibrate the voice-match threshold against real speech instead of guesses.

5702 Aug, 19:11
72 tools**Asked whether she can search Reddit specifically and how to phrase it, and whether a Harry Potter epub just dropped into the library folder actually works.**

Found Reddit searches were only catching half the phrasings tried, since none of them contained any existing trigger phrase as a literal substring — added `"reddit"` itself as a trigger, verified against all four. Confirmed `.epub` had never been a supported format, built extraction for it, and verified it end to end in the packaged executable — which also settled a real question, that pure-Python packages like `pypdf` don't appear as files in a frozen build, so running the exe rather than searching its folder was the only real test.

5802 Aug, 20:00
1 tools**Confirmed she can read now, and noted he'd keep PDF formats in mind.**

Confirmed it, with the practical detail: `.epub`, `.pdf`, `.txt` and `.md` all work, and "read my files" is what actually starts the indexing. Also cleared up a stale editor tab pointing at a test file that had already been deleted.

5902 Aug, 20:01
7 tools**Pointed out Reddit was only an example — asked about YouTube, and whether controlling YouTube Music would work.**

Two separate answers, both verified rather than assumed. Added `"youtube"` as a lookup trigger, the same fix as Reddit, tested against four phrasings plus two that should *not* trigger. For playback: no change was needed — the media control never knew which app it was talking to in the first place, it asks Windows for whatever session is active. Confirmed live by checking it correctly picked up a browser tab, which is what actually proves it's app-agnostic rather than just Spotify-shaped.

6002 Aug, 20:04
0 tools**Confirmed search alone is enough — no need for her to summarise what's said inside a video.**

Agreed, and left it there rather than building toward it.

- 61** Asked for the docs to be brought current, and whether he could call this assistant Cia.
02 Aug, 20:05 This document and the others. On the name: yes — and worth noting it fits the pattern, since Lia was named the same way.
9 tools
-

Imagining a face

- 62** Floated giving Lia a face — a hovering presence on screen rather than a tray icon.
02 Aug, 20:26 Recommended starting minimal (a small always-on-top overlay with idle / listening / speaking states wired to flags the loop already tracks) and flagged the real cost honestly: everything built so far has been headless, so a window that renders continuously is a new kind of component and a new failure surface.
0 tools
-

- 63** Recognised the CPU cost that would come with it.
02 Aug, 20:27 Clarified the scale — a few static states redrawn only on change is far closer to "a window sitting there" than to an animated avatar.
0 tools
-

- 64** Said he was picturing something 3D, with patterns shifting as she speaks.
02 Aug, 20:28 Flagged the two genuinely hard parts before any code: nothing in the project touches graphics at all yet, and Piper returns raw audio with no phoneme timings, so "reacting to speech" realistically means animating off volume rather than true lip-sync. Recommended 2D/2.5D driven by that volume signal — most of the feeling, none of the GPU contention with the model on a 4GB card.
0 tools
-

- 65** Asked how long a 2D/2.5D version would take, and whether the requirements file was genuinely complete.
02 Aug, 20:30 Estimated about a day of coding split across the overlay window, the art states, and wiring to her existing voice flags — noting the real variable is art polish, not code. Re-audited `requirements.txt` by walking every import in the codebase with an AST parse rather than trusting the earlier pass: genuinely complete.
2 tools
-

- 66** Decided to spend a week actually using her before building anything else.
02 Aug, 20:39 Endorsed it as the right order — several real bugs in this project were only ever found by living with her. Listed what the week should specifically calibrate: the voice match threshold against real speech, whether the passcode gate felt right day to day, alarms across real sleep/wake cycles, and the conversation window timing.
3 tools
-

- 67** Confirmed she was closed, and asked whether just running the app brings her back.
02 Aug, 20:40 Yes — everything lives in the database on disk, independent of the process. Noted the single-instance lock only matters if she's already running, and that every fresh start opened a locked session, so the identity phrase had to come first.
5 tools
-

- 68** Raised the time she takes to reply, mentioning he speaks fast.
02 Aug, 20:43 Separated the two possibilities rather than guessing which he meant: generation latency (cold starts, model size) versus her cutting in early because a fast talker's natural pauses read as "finished" — a one-line VAD change if it's the second.
0 tools
-

- 69** Thanked and closed out the session.
02 Aug, 20:49 —
0 tools
-

What a week of real use broke

70

02 Aug, 21:00
6 tools

Asked whether a better model existed — Ollama felt slow and memory-hungry, and her replies seemed unorganised, always circling back to earlier conversations.

Checked both rather than accepting the premise. ollama ps showed a third of the model spilling to CPU — a 4GB-VRAM constraint, which a bigger model makes worse, not better. The rambling turned out to be a real bug and nothing to do with model quality: memory retrieval always injected its closest four past turns no matter how weak the match, with no relevance floor at all — so unrelated small talk from days ago arrived every turn labelled as things he'd told her.

71

02 Aug, 21:04
26 tools

Approved the fix, and added that "read my files" always dragged in yesterday's chatter too.

Added MEMORY_MIN_SCORE, then **measured it against his actual stored conversations instead of copying the library's threshold** — at 0.45 the noise still got through (unrelated greetings scored 0.46–0.50 against "read my files"), while genuinely relevant memories ran 0.6–1.0. Set to 0.55 on that evidence. Separately found the library command never spoke its result at all, so a voice-triggered scan answered with silence.

72

02 Aug, 21:14
12 tools

Reported from real use: "read my files" did nothing she understood, and asked to play YouTube Music she claimed to be playing something he couldn't hear.

Tested the exact phrasing and found the cause — spoken_command() capped requests at six words and only matched at the very start or end, so a request wrapped in context ("I've opened YouTube Music on a browser tab, can you play the music?") was discarded before any command check, fell through to conversation, and the model invented a confirmation. Verified the underlying media control was fine by resuming his actually-paused browser session, then removed the cap and matched anywhere in the sentence.

73

02 Aug, 21:25
2 tools

Explained he'd been varying his phrasing deliberately, wanting her to feel human, and had assumed the model was at fault when it failed.

Confirmed the model never saw those requests at all — they were rejected by the matcher in front of it, and only then did it fill the silence with a guess. The structural gap was in the code, not the model's capability.

74

02 Aug, 21:28
4 tools

Said plainly he didn't want rigid matching — he wants a companion.

Tested whether the local model could decide intent itself, rather than promising it: given real tool definitions it correctly routed natural phrasing and left ordinary conversation alone — but running the same request eight times, it silently did nothing on the eighth. Recommended layering the two (fast reliable matching first, model understanding as the fallback) rather than replacing one with the other, and gave the measured reliability rather than a claim.

75

02 Aug, 21:46
0 tools

Chose to hold that until after the test week.

—

76

03 Aug, 16:36
16 tools

Three findings from real use: she froze for a while, gave wrong answers about time and volume, and still claimed to be playing music she wasn't.

Read her actual log rather than guessing; all three were real. The freeze was the library scan running inline on the conversation loop — roughly 590 embedding calls for one novel, twenty minutes of genuine unresponsiveness, on the one path that hadn't been backgrounded. Time and volume were pure invention because she had access to neither, so both were handed to her directly each turn, fixing every phrasing at once. And "increase the volume" was never a known phrase at all. **The largest finding: the packaged app he was testing predated every fix made that day**, so none of them had ever reached him.

77

03 Aug, 17:21
78 tools

Asked to remove the passcode system entirely — the ENCODE and DECODE words.

Removed the whole access gate: both passcodes, the session lock, the document-reading command, and their config, docs and build steps — keeping voice recognition, which was always a separate, softer signal. Rebuilding the executable then surfaced a further real bug: volume control worked from source but failed silently in the packaged app, because COM was never initialised on that thread. Fixed, and every media call now says why it failed instead of failing quietly, which is what made these so hard to catch.

78

04 Aug, 08:51
1 tools

Asked what the actual constraint is on making her as intelligent as a frontier model.

Gave the real numbers rather than a shrug: an RTX 2050 with 4GB of VRAM fits roughly a 3B model, which already spills a third of itself to CPU at 8k context — the next tier up wouldn't fit at all, and frontier models are two to three orders of magnitude larger across whole racks of 80GB cards. No local model on this machine reaches that. But flagged the part that actually mattered: **most of what felt unintelligent this week was structural bugs, not the model's ceiling** — the invented time and volume, the phantom music, the memory noise — all since fixed. Laid out the four real options and named the hybrid as the only genuine step up, with its cost being privacy rather than money.

79

04 Aug, 09:09
40 tools

Asked to keep improving her.

Built the intent layer that had been deferred: when no phrase matches, the model is shown the actions she can take and asked what was meant, with the deterministic matcher still in front for speed and predictability. Measured at 30/32 with no false positives on conversation — reached only after two failed attempts, where abstract rules turned the volume up on “I couldn't hear you earlier” 5/5 and ignored “I've added a book, go have a look” 5/5, and concrete examples fixed both.

80

04 Aug, 10:03
4 tools

Asked whether hosted API keys could replace the 3B, or whether he could train his own model, starting with TTS.

Separated three things that had been rolled together. Hosted API: feasible, keys already set, real intelligence gain, cost is privacy. Training an LLM: not viable — fine-tuning needs more VRAM than inference, and more importantly teaches style, not reasoning. Training a TTS voice: genuinely feasible on this hardware, but changes how she *sounds*, not how she thinks — the two were being conflated.

81

04 Aug, 10:10
5 tools

Asked exactly what would leave the machine on a free OpenRouter tier — does the diary stay local?

Corrected an earlier answer that had been too loose. Checked the code: it isn't just the sentence spoken — stored facts, retrieved memories, matching document passages and **her diary reflections** all go into the prompt, so all of it would leave. Voice audio never does, since transcription is local. Flagged plainly that free endpoints are the *least* private option, not a neutral one, and offered a stripped-context middle path.

82

04 Aug, 10:20
0 tools

Chose to stay on the local 3B, but asked for a better conversational model.

Named the realistic candidates for a 4GB card and what each costs, and flagged that media and volume control are Windows API calls that cost no VRAM at all — there was no need to trade them away.

83

04 Aug, 10:24
1 tools

Asked, pointedly, what the benefit is if a same-size model turns out no smarter.

Answered honestly: possibly nothing. The one concrete gain would be tool-calling reliability, which the intent layer runs on. Recommended *against* the swap for now — the version that made him think she was unintelligent was the stale executable with none of the day's fixes, so the cheapest useful step is simply using the rebuilt one first.

84

04 Aug, 10:26
12 tools

Asked which document formats she can read.

Listed the five supported, and the ones people assume work but don't — scanned PDFs (no OCR), Kindle formats, and Word. Noticed while checking that his Harry Potter file was still sitting unread.

8504 Aug, 10:30
32 tools**Asked how much of a book she gets through in ten minutes.**

Measured it on his own hardware with real text from his own book rather than estimating: 2.3 seconds per passage, about 130 pages per ten minutes. That exposed a documented figure that was wrong by 4.5× — 'about half a second per passage' had never been timed. Corrected it everywhere. Also checked whether VRAM contention was the cause and found it wasn't: freeing 3.5GB changed the rate by 0.02s.

8604 Aug, 10:48
32 tools**Asked for Word document support, and for her to say how long a scan will take — or simply “on it”.**

Added .docx (including table contents, which are real content and were worth not silently dropping) and verified it inside the packaged executable, the case PyInstaller is most likely to miss. Counting passages up front costs 0.3s against ~23 minutes of indexing, so she now states a real figure rather than a guess — “On it” for something short, “On it, that'll take around 25 minutes” for a book. Found while testing that the Harry Potter novel had in fact finished indexing overnight, and confirmed retrieval genuinely works against it.

8704 Aug, 11:11
9 tools**Wanted naps covered: “remind me in 5 min”, and being woken by specific words — “wake me by saying please wake up” — plus the other ways of saying the same thing.**

The first phrasing already worked; the second only half did, setting the timer but then answering with “your 5 minute timer is up” instead of the words asked for. Alarms now store the finished sentence rather than a label, so requested words are said verbatim, and “remind me to stretch” becomes “Time to stretch.” Widened the parser to spoken numbers, “half an hour”, “a couple of minutes”, “half past three”, and to the other ways people ask (“give me a nudge”, “buzz me”, “let me know”) — several of which had been parsing their time correctly and then being discarded for lacking an approved keyword. Also fixed “set a timer for 5”, which had been setting an alarm for five o'clock. Verified 9 real phrasings all schedule and 8 conversational sentences containing times still don't, then watched a real alarm fire and say “Please wake up.”

8804 Aug, 11:22
18 tools**Asked for a full re-run checking everything discussed so far.**

18 automated checks plus a live run of the packaged app: no passcode gate, the real clock, the real volume, an alarm set with his own words, natural phrasing routed correctly, and a question answered from the indexed novel.

Deciding what she does on her own

8904 Aug, 11:35
15 tools**Noticed her diary entry from that test run was odd, and asked whether it could be fixed.**

It could, and it mattered more than it looked. Days of testing had been writing into her real memory — a dozen piped “hello”s stored as turns, and a diary entry per run reflecting on conversations that never happened, one of which characterised him as “moving between unrelated topics” from a list of test commands. Removed 4 fabricated entries and 12 memories across both databases (after backing them up), and added - - no - save so testing leaves nothing behind.

9006 Aug, 07:05
0 tools**Asked for another complete test.**

21 checks, all passing. Found in the process that - - no - save didn't reach the packaged app at all — the exe starts from app.py, which never runs main.py's entry block, so the flag existed but did nothing precisely where the polluting testing happened. Fixed and verified. Also noted honestly that her answer about the novel was worse this run than last: retrieval found the right passage both times, but the 3B garbled the details, calling Harry “Dudley's little brother”.

9106 Aug, 07:06
0 tools**Asked whether to train her as a new LLM.**

No, plainly. Training from scratch is millions of dollars of compute; fine-tuning a 3B needs more VRAM than inference and, more to the point, teaches style rather than reasoning — it wouldn't fix the error he'd just seen. Pointed at the cheaper levers instead, in order.

92

06 Aug, 07:10
1 tools**Asked about training a quantized small custom model instead.**

A sharper question, and given a real answer: his model is already 4-bit quantized, and QLoRA is the technique that makes low-VRAM fine-tuning viable — 0.5B to 1B fits in his 4GB, 3B doesn't. Named the one case where it genuinely wins: narrow classification, which his intent router happens to be. Recommended waiting until real use had produced real training data rather than inventing examples.

93

06 Aug, 07:19
55 tools**Asked whether the Amy voice is free or subscription.**

Free, open-source Piper, already sitting on disk as a 63MB file — along with two others he'd downloaded. Flagged honestly that the voice files record their dataset but not their licence, so the exact terms should be checked per voice if he ever publishes anything with one.

94

06 Aug, 10:46
0 tools**Six changes: wait to be woken rather than greeting on her own; convert documents to text once; play music from her own library by number; remember only what he tells her; add Notion access; and start logging intents for a future fine-tune.**

Notion dropped at his request. The other five built and verified end to end in the packaged app: she now starts silent, documents convert once (25× faster to re-read, though honestly *larger* on disk for epub, which is already compressed), a new `music.py` plays her own files by number through her own audio and ducks them under her voice, memory is explicit-only with duplicates refused, and every interpretation is logged as training data. Two bugs caught while testing: “play number 3” was being claimed by the media remote, and - - no - save didn't cover explicit remembering.

95

06 Aug, 10:46
16 tools

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96

06 Aug, 11:25
45 tools**Reported she was having trouble reading and “keeps calling me out”, and asked for the conversion step to be removed so he could do it by hand.**

Removed the conversion cache as asked. The two complaints turned out to share one cause, found by reading her actual stored memories rather than reasoning from the symptoms: **she was recording her own voice as things Wade had said** and quoting them back to him. Echo detection only ran while she was mid-sentence, so her spoken confirmations were heard a moment after she finished and stored as his turns; and Whisper hands its vocabulary hint back as a transcript when given near-silence, so “This is a conversation with Lia” was stored as his words five times over. Both filtered on every input path, and the contaminated memories deleted. Name repetition fixed separately in code, since asking a 3B to use it sparingly doesn't take.

What it came to

A companion called Wade knows by name, that starts at login, greets him, listens on an open mic, answers out loud, remembers across days, reads what he hands her, sets real alarms and timers, controls whatever's playing and the system volume, recognises his voice, and now gates every session behind either that or a spoken passcode — and never sends a word off the machine except the one narrow, optional exception she'll admit to: weather, and a question explicitly asked of the web. Thirteen modules, single-instance protected, running at roughly 4% of one core while idle instead of 290%.

Still open: no way to forget, she still occasionally invents small details, fact keys drift, there are no tests, and voice recognition's real-world accuracy is honestly unverified — tested only against synthetic voices, tunable via `/whoami` once there's real data to tune it against. Two real bugs (an access gate that could trap you in the conversation, an identity phrase silently lost when combined with a request) were found only by actually running the thing, not by reasoning about the code — the same lesson as the CPU issue and the alarm parsing bug before it.